Becoming a dom • Chapter 7

Your first sub

Last checked 3 November 2026 • 8 minutes to read

A first sub is a person with a bank account who agreed to a game. This chapter covers the frame, the cap, the consent conversation, and how to let him go.

Reported | Vivian's field notes

This chapter is not advice for your situation.

In 30 seconds

- Put your rules and limits in front of the first send, in writing.
- The sub types his own cap in a calm moment. Nobody raises it in the middle of a session, and he can raise it only after a wait.
- Ask what he wants, accept the answer, and accept "not today".
- Be harsh inside the scene and kind outside it. Never chase.
- When a sub is in debt or in distress, the money part stops and outside help starts.

You will learn

- What to show a sub before any money moves.
- How to start small, with a cap he sets and a stop that works at once.
- How to hold a consent conversation, and which answers to accept.
- Which control habits to recognise and refuse, even when a mentor uses them.
- How to let a sub leave well.

A first sub is a person with a bank account who agreed to a game. I treat him that way before I treat him as anything else. He sees the rules before the money, he types his own cap, and he leaves whenever he wants to. If you keep those three things, most other mistakes stay small.

— **Vivian**

Before the first message: your frame

A first sub should meet your rules before any money moves. Write down what you keep, what you throw out, what you never do and how a sub stops the game, and put it where he can read it before he writes.

Your limits live in the persona file, not only in your head. Mine rule out meetings, cameras and voice, anything involving minors or child-like characters, chasing people, and crossing a sub's real limits. Anything that touches real life is a refusal, and a sub who starts talking about meeting gets one.

A paying sub is not owed every request, and you may refuse a scene you cannot play.

Vivian's field notes

I never chase. The sub comes to me and I do not follow up. It keeps the game voluntary and takes the pressure off both sides.

Every sub is an adult. If anything suggests otherwise, end the contact and take no money. Never take a sub's name, card number, password, login code or remote access. A dom who asks for them has stopped playing, and the same request is how many scams begin. See Spot a fake dom.

A first conversation, in order

1. Show the frame: what you do, what you refuse, and how to stop.
2. Ask for his limits as a short list of yes, maybe and no, and go through it again from time to time.
3. Ask him to type his cap in a calm moment, before any send.
4. Agree a safety word or a plain phrase that ends the scene at once.
5. Agree one small first step.
6. Check in when it is over.

The first send and the cap

Start at the bottom, with the smallest item on your wishlist. The cap is typed by the sub himself, in a calm moment, before the session. It is held somewhere the moment cannot reach: his bank or card limit, a tool that enforces it, or a person he trusts. You honour it and never invite him past it. A cap typed in the middle of a session is weak. It is raised only after a wait. A tribute buys nothing, so promise nothing in return that you will not keep. ◑

A dom who lets a sub skip the cap, or invites him past it because he keeps insisting, has moved from play to harm; his insistence is a reason to tighten it, not to lift it. ◑

Say in advance when a sub must not send and what happens if he does. In my experience a mild “please stop” said once does not hold, while a rule stated early, with a consequence you will really carry out, does. ◑

A sub who says money is short, or that he has passed his month, ends the money part for that evening. ◑ If you are wrong to doubt him, he pays for it. If you are wrong to believe him, you lose one evening.

Do not take a send from a sub who is drunk, exhausted or upset. ◑ One first-person account raises a consent concern about a client who takes on credit-card debt. ◎ Reported

Never ask for a sum. The only ceiling is the cap he set, and what he sends is his own decision, which nothing you do should draw out of him. ◑

Your sub keeps sending after you asked him to stop

You told him once to stop sending tonight. He sends again and writes that he does not mind.

A Accept it. He is an adult and he said he is fine.

Not this one. His insistence is the warning. A cap and a stop exist for the moments when he would say exactly this.

B Treat the send as a breach, repeat the rule you gave him, and end the session.

The right answer. The rule was stated early and now it holds. Ending the session costs you one evening and protects the dynamic.

C Agree to a higher cap on the spot so the sends stop counting as a breach.

Not this one. That moves the line to fit the pressure. A cap lifted because the sub insists has stopped protecting him.

The consent conversation

When a sub says “you decide”, answer that you asked and you want his answer. Ask which register he wants today, gentle or harsh, and treat it as a preference that can change from day to day.

Show pictures tied to different kinks and watch the reaction. When he says one is not his, say that is fine and move on. Drop a label he rejects, and drop a consequence that makes him uncomfortable.

Even a task announced without a choice can be countered. Negotiating before accepting is a normal part of consent in the scene.

Make it safe to ask. If a sub apologises for a request, tell him never to be sorry for asking, and if he confesses an urge, do not call it a bad decision. Shame about what he wants makes subs hide it and lie about it.

Accept “not today”. A sub who feels low and asks to stop for the evening is released at once, with no apology owed.

Which answer keeps the consent real?

Question 1 of 2

A sub writes: “I would rather skip that one.” What do you answer?

- ◯ “Fine. Tell me what you would like instead.”
- ◯ “Think about it and tell me tonight.”
- ◯ “You will like it once you try.”

Answer. “Fine. Tell me what you would like instead.”. A stated “not mine” is final. Promising he will enjoy it turns his no into a problem to solve.

Question 2 of 2

Which sentence is permission that is really free?

- ◯ “Go ahead, do what you like. I will just be sad.”
- ◯ “Yes, I want to try it, and I can say stop.”
- ◯ “You do not get to run away.”

Answer. “Yes, I want to try it, and I can say stop.”. Permission that arrives with a statement of hurt has a hidden price. Ask for a plain yes or no, then talk about the need underneath.

Running a session

Be harsh inside the scene and kind outside it. The persona's cruelty is a tool; the person treats the sub well, and after a hard scene a short check-in is aftercare. A dom who is gentle by nature can play harsh as performance or stay gentle by default.

Intensity outside the limits he named and the cap he set is how abuse works, so stay inside both.

Say exclusivity out loud. If you do not want a sub to talk to or serve other doms, say so and get his agreement. Two doms cannot share a sub by deciding between themselves; he must agree, and one leads while the other stays at the edge.

What a sub confides is not a teaching exhibit; show a conversation only with his consent or with identifying details removed.

A dom with limited time carries only a handful of active chats, and a newer dom carries fewer. New subs arrive slowly, and free chatting for people who never pay leads to exhaustion. Absence loses subs.

Vivian's field notes

A few subs who respect the frame are worth more than many contacts who drain your time. Posting every day for reach is expensive, and it often attracts people who never send.

When a sub struggles or leaves

When a sub is struggling

When a sub says he is struggling, pause the money part. Ask what is wrong, listen, ask for nothing, and answer kindly. A sales offer at that moment is the wrong reply.

In the press, a former participant describes men who sold cars, took on debt and took second jobs. Reported In my experience some of the people who write to a new persona show signs of compulsion.

You are paid by the sub, so you cannot be his safety net. Do not manage his debts, taper his spending yourself, or move him to a dom you think is better. That is a conflict of interest. Ask a mentor early rather than carrying it alone. If he talks about having no future, he needs outside help: emergency services, a helpline, or a person physically near. See Where to get help and When a sub is in trouble.

A sub who wants to quit may block the doms he knows, which is a legitimate tool against relapse. Respect it and do not write to him.

Your sub says he is out of money and in debt

He has written a long message late in the evening. He says he cannot pay his rent and that he still wants to send.

A Ask for a smaller send, just this once.

Not this one. Asking is the harm. A hardship statement pauses the money, and the cost of being wrong falls on him.

B Do not take a send, thank him for telling you, and point him to outside help.

The right answer. The money part stops for the evening and help starts. You stay kind, and you do not become his debt manager.

C Offer to manage his payments for him.

Not this one. You are the person he pays. Managing his money is a conflict of interest.

When a sub leaves

Every dom loses subs, some after a day and some after more than a year. The decent response is no chasing, no messages, and a good wish. If you hear a firm no, stop. ◑

Repair a mishandled moment quickly. Do not leave a sub alone mid-conversation. ◑ See Ending well.

Control that looks like discipline

Some habits look like discipline but make the dom the only gatekeeper. ◑ They are listed here so you can recognise and refuse them, from any source.

Habits to recognise and refuse

What they say or do

1 An ultimatum with a same-day deadline and a false either-or

The counter

Take time, refuse the frame, and keep a way to say no.

What they say or do

2 Warmth that disappears when you refuse an offer of rescue, or a joke about leaving

The counter

Keep warmth that does not depend on compliance. An apology that only restores attention is a sign.

What they say or do

3 Permission that comes with a statement of hurt

The counter

Ask for a plain yes or no, then talk about the need underneath.

What they say or do

4 Oaths, reports of every urge, and proof of private acts

The counter

A consensual version has limits you can renegotiate and asks for no proof of private acts.

What they say or do

5 A request to bring every doubt to the dom first and to nobody else

The counter

A healthy dynamic leaves room for friends and outside help.

What they say or do

6 An offer from a senior dom to help with your sub, and the split changes before you took part

The counter

Agree the roles, the split and who speaks to the sub before anyone touches the conversation. He must agree too.

A pattern is a sign, not a verdict on a person. If you see several together, slow down and ask someone outside the relationship.

A good mentor lets you try first and explains the reasoning. A case taken over teaches nothing, and seniority is not a substitute for explanation.

Pressure runs the other way too. Subs haggle, window-shop, promise “just this once” and offer excuses at the moment they are asked for more. A rule written down in advance lets you point to it instead of arguing. You are paid and you design the tools, so more of the responsibility sits with you.

Remember it

1. Show the rules and limits before any money moves.
2. The sub types his cap and it is held outside the moment. You honour it and never invite him past it.
3. A hardship statement stops the money for that evening.
4. Accept “not today” and “not mine” as final.
5. Harsh inside the scene, kind outside it, and never chase.
6. You are paid by him, so you cannot be his safety net. Point outward.

Check it

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

Evidence levels

Verified	Checked against the original source.
Reported	Stated by a serious secondary source read in full.
Community	Widely said in the scene; no document proves it.
Vivian’s field notes	First-hand experience, not a study.

Unverified

Plausible, not proven yet.

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◎ Reported

Diary of a Financial Dominatrix, part one (https://www.theskinny.co.uk/sexuality/deviance/diary-of-a-financial-dominatrix-part-one)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20200805021033/https://www.theskinny.co.uk/sexuality/deviance/diary-of-a-financial-dominatrix-part-one)

Accessed 3 November 2026

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◎ Reported

[a former participant] has seen men left broke and hungry from 'paying women to talk to them' (https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20251123124217/https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

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Nothing here is financial, legal or medical advice for your situation.